

5 NIGHTS • 6 DAYS • KASHMIR VALLEY • HIMALAYAS

Paradise on the Earth

A bespoke alpine journey across cedar-scented valleys, heritage Dal Lake houseboats, gilded saffron meadows, and snow-crowned Himalayan passes.

⊕ Srinagar (2N) → Gulmarg (1N) → Pahalgam (2N) → Srinagar Out ✈

EXPEDITION PARAMETERS



DURATION
5N / 6D
All Season Curated



PARTY SIZE
2 - 6 Guests
Private Dedicated
Chauffeur



PACING
**Leisurely &
Scenic**
No Rush Transfers



STYLE
**Bespoke
Heritage**
Palaces & Pine
Chalets

CURATED JOURNEY OUTLINE

Journey Blueprint

From the gentle ripples of Dal Lake traversed by silent wooden shikaras to the sky-piercing peaks of Apharwat, Kashmir is an poetry of light, timber, and snow. This journey pairs regal heritage stays in **Srinagar** with the alpine thrills of the world's highest cable car in **Gulmarg** and the pastoral grandeur of Lidder River in **Pahalgam**. Thoughtfully unhurried, each day is crafted with private logistics, cultural depth, and heartfelt Kashmiri hospitality.

+

THE ROUTE

Srinagar (1N) → Gulmarg (1N) → Pahalgam (2N) → Srinagar Heritage Houseboat (1N) → Departure.

🏠

ACCOMMODATION

Curated 5-star boutique resort, alpine heated pine chalet in Gulmarg, luxury river retreat, and handcrafted cedar houseboat.

🚗

PRIVATE TRANSPORT

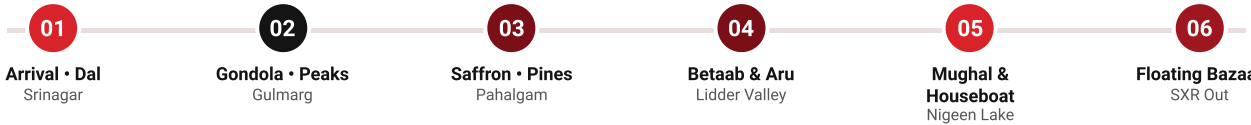
Dedicated Toyota Innova Crysta with seasoned valley chauffeur across all transfers and sightseeing tours.

🍴

INCLUDED MEALS

Daily artisanal breakfasts and gourmet multi-course dinners included at all resorts and on the luxury houseboat.

YOUR 6 DAYS AT A GLANCE



SIGNATURE HIGHLIGHTS

DAY 01 HIGHLIGHT

Sunset Shikara Ride with Hot Saffron Kehwa

DAY 02 HIGHLIGHT

Apharwat Peak via Gulmarg Gondola Phase II

DAY 04 HIGHLIGHT

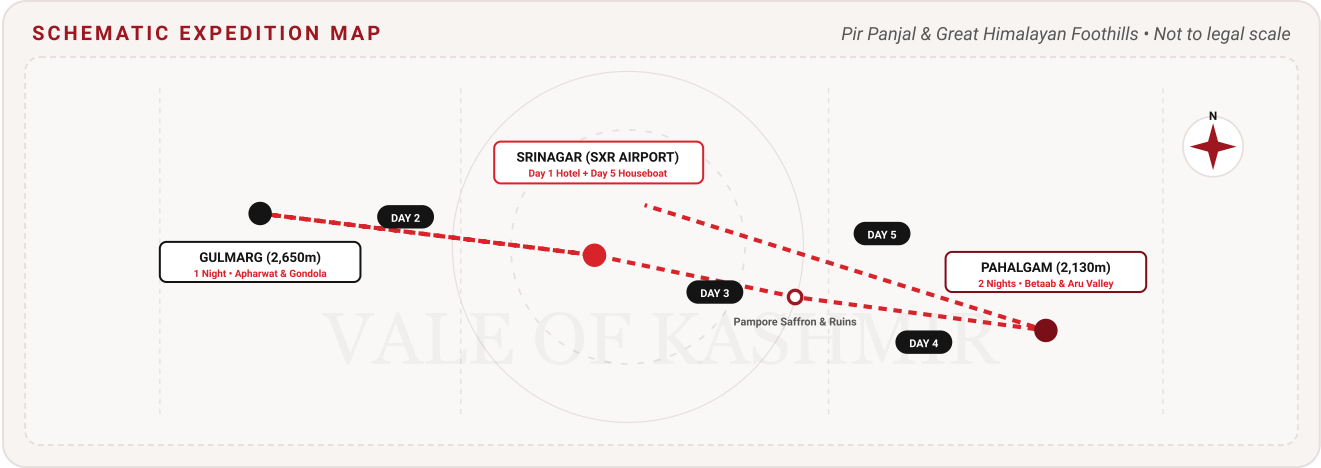
Lidder River Picnic & Betaab Valley Exploration

DAY 05 HIGHLIGHT

Carved Walnut Wood Heritage Houseboat Stay

GEOGRAPHIC TRAJECTORY

Route Topology & Culinary Schedule



CULINARY PROVISIONING

DAY	BASE STAY	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER
Day 01	The Lalit Grand Palace / Vivanta, Srinagar	— En Route	— At Leisure	✔ Included (Hotel)
Day 02	The Khyber Himalayan Resort, Gulmarg	✔ Included	— High Alpine Cafe Phase I	✔ Included (Resort)
Day 03	Pine N Peak / Radisson, Pahalgam	✔ Included	— Pampore Saffron Tearoom	✔ Included (Resort)
Day 04	Pine N Peak / Radisson, Pahalgam	✔ Included	✔ Riverside Curated Picnic	✔ Included (Resort)
Day 05	Sukoon Luxury Houseboat, Nigeen/Dal	✔ Included	— Old City Wazwan Bistro	✔ Traditional Royal Wazwan
Day 06	Homeward Bound • Out	✔ Houseboat Deck Breakfast	— En Route Airport	— Flight Service

*Note: Meals marked as — are intentionally left unbundled so you can savor local street specialties like fresh girda bread, walnut fudge, and Kashmiri Harissa at your leisure.



Summer Palaces, Alpine Meadows & Saffron Fields

SRINAGAR, GULMARG PLATEAU & PIR PANJAL

DAYS 01 - 03

DAY

01



Arrival in Srinagar & Sunset Shikara on Dal Lake

📍 **Base:** Srinagar

🏠 **Stay:** The Lalit Grand Palace / Vivanta

🍽️ **Meals:** Dinner

- ◆ Touchdown at Sheikh ul-Alam International Airport (SXR); meet your private mountain chauffeur and transfer to your grand heritage resort overlooking Dal Lake.
- ◆ Late afternoon private wooden **Shikara ride** across Dal Lake, floating past the Char Chinar island, lotus gardens, and serene floating hamlets.
- ◆ Sip steaming authentic saffron-infused *Kehwa* served on the water while watching the amber sunset reflect over Zabbarwan mountains, followed by a welcome dinner.

DAY

02



Gulmarg Meadow of Flowers & Apharwat Peak

📍 **Base:** Gulmarg

🏠 **Stay:** The Khyber Himalayan Resort

🍽️ **Meals:** Breakfast, Dinner

- ◆ Scenic morning ascent through Tangmarg's towering deodar and pine groves into the high-altitude bowl of **Gulmarg** (2,650 meters).
- ◆ Board the famed **Gulmarg Gondola (Phase I to Kongdoori & Phase II to Apharwat Peak at 4,200m)** for sweeping panoramic views of Nanga Parbat and the Pir Panjal range.
- ◆ Leisurely stroll past the historic St. Mary's Church and the historic Maharaja Palace before checking in to your luxury heated alpine chalet.

DAY

03



Gulmarg to Pahalgam via Pampore Saffron & Ruins

📍 **Base:** Pahalgam

🏠 **Stay:** Pine N Peak / Radisson Resort

🍽️ **Meals:** Breakfast, Dinner

- ◆ Descend toward South Kashmir along the scenic national highway, pausing at the purple saffron plateau fields of **Pampore** for fresh saffron and honey tasting.
- ◆ Explore the 9th-century monolithic stone temple ruins of **Awantipora** dedicated to Lord Vishnu, constructed by King Avantivarman.
- ◆ Drive along the turquoise glacial torrents of the Lidder River into **Pahalgam (Valley of Shepherds)** and settle into your riverbank sanctuary.



Glacial Rivers, Mughal Heritage & Lake Tranquility

BETAAB VALLEY, NIGEEN LAKE & SRINAGAR FLOATING BAZAAR

DAYS 04 - 06

DAY

04



Enchanting Valleys of Pahalgam: Betaab & Aru


Base: Pahalgam


Stay: Pine N Peak / Radisson Resort


Meals: Breakfast, Picnic Lunch, Dinner

- ◆ Morning excursion by dedicated local vehicle to **Aru Valley**, a pristine meadow framed by snow-covered peaks and traditional wooden Gujjar huts.
- ◆ Continue to the picturesque **Betaab Valley** (Hajan Valley) for a curated gourmet picnic spread beside pine forests and bubbling streams.
- ◆ Afternoon visit to Chandanwari, the historical gateway of the Amarnath Yatra; evening at leisure by the Lidder River listening to the glacial waters.

DAY

05



Mughal Terraces & Handcrafted Luxury Houseboat


Base: Srinagar (Nigeen Lake)


Stay: Sukoon Luxury Houseboat


Meals: Breakfast, Royal Wazwan Dinner

- ◆ Drive back to Srinagar; wander through the terraced Persian architecture of **Nishat Bagh (Garden of Bliss)** and **Shalimar Bagh** built by Emperor Jahangir.
- ◆ Check in to the elite **Sukoon Luxury Houseboat** on the peaceful Nigeen Lake, admiring ornate hand-carved cedar wood paneling and crewel embroidery.
- ◆ Sunset Shikara ride through hidden water channels, culminating in a candlelit **Traditional 7-Course Kashmiri Wazwan Feast** on the houseboat deck.

DAY

06



Dawn Floating Vegetable Market to Srinagar Airport


Base: Departure Hub


Meals: Houseboat Deck Breakfast

- ◆ Early morning sunrise Shikara excursion to witness the centuries-old **Floating Vegetable Market** on Dal Lake, a vibrant barter exchange among local farmers.
- ◆ Hearty breakfast on the sun deck followed by a brief visit to a master artisan's workshop for Pashmina shawls and hand-knotted silk carpets.
- ◆ Assisted transfer to Srinagar International Airport (SXR) with personalized escort, carrying home memories of paradise.

Until the next journey.
 Every trail curated with personal reverence for the landscapes we love.



— CLEAR & TRANSPARENT TERMS

What Is Included & Excluded

✓ WHAT IS INCLUDED	✕ WHAT IS EXCLUDED
 5 Nights Luxury Stays Handpicked 5-star properties: 1N Srinagar Palace, 1N The Khyber Gulmarg, 2N Pine N Peak Pahalgam, 1N Sukoon Houseboat.	 Airfare To/From Srinagar Inbound/outbound flights into Sheikh ul-Alam International Airport (can be ticketed upon request).
 Dedicated Chauffeur & SUV Private Toyota Innova Crysta for all airport transfers, inter-valley journeys, fuel, toll taxes, and driver boarding.	 Gulmarg Gondola Tickets Phase I & II tickets (booked online under guest name as per strict J&K Cable Car Corp ID rules; we assist with slots).
 Pahalgam Internal Union Vehicle Dedicated local taxi for excursion to Aru Valley, Betaab Valley, and Chandanwari as mandated by local taxi guild.	 Pony / Horse Rides & Snow Gear Pony rentals in Gulmarg / Baisaran, gumboot or winter coat rentals, and ski equipment hire.
 Curated Meal Provisions Daily sumptuous breakfasts, 5 bespoke dinners including an authentic 7-course traditional royal Kashmiri Wazwan feast.	 Insurance & Medical Costs Comprehensive travel, baggage loss, emergency medical, or high-altitude flight delay insurance.
 Two Private Shikara Rides 1-hour sunset cruise on Dal Lake with warm Kehwa, plus dawn cruise to the authentic floating vegetable market.	 Discretionary Gratuities Voluntary tips for your chauffeur, Shikara rowers, luggage porters, or hotel dining staff.


OPTIONAL BESPOKE ENHANCEMENTS AVAILABLE
 Upgrade to a private helicopter transfer from Srinagar to Gulmarg/Pahalgam, add a dedicated certified naturalist for birding in Dachigam National Park, or book private ski lessons at Apharwat.

— THE MAD COMPASS WAY

How We Bring Your Journey To Life

1

Personalized Consultation

We understand your seasonality preferences (blooming tulips in spring, meadows in summer, or snowscapes in winter) to set the ideal pace.

2

Fine-Tuning & Precision

We secure coveted room categories at high-demand boutique chalets, coordinate Gondola slot timings, and assign vetted valley chauffeurs.

3

Seamless Execution & 24/7 Care

From your Srinagar touchdown to departure, our operations team actively monitors high-altitude weather and pass clearances in real time.

Flexible Amendments & Bespoke Guarantee: All Mad Compass private signature itineraries in Kashmir feature active ground support and backup contingencies, ensuring seamless adjustments if weather conditions or flight timings shift.

Ready when you are.

Let us calibrate this Kashmir journey to your exact dates, party preferences, and travel style.

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12+

YEARS ACTIVE IN CURATION

300+

SIGNATURE TRIPS PLANNED

25+

EXOTIC DESTINATIONS